

Athena Zhong

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EDUCATION

University of Pennsylvania

Philadelphia, PA

M.S.E. in Scientific Computing; B.A. in Cognitive Science; Double Major in Philosophy

Expected May 2026

- **Cumulative GPA:** 3.95 / 4.00; **Honors:** University Scholars, Dean's List
- **Relevant Coursework:** Machine Learning, Modern Convex Optimization, Numerical Methods for PDEs, Natural Language Processing, Computational Biology, Kant, Philosophy of Epistemology, Logic, Probability, Cognitive Neuroscience, etc.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Goldman Sachs

San Francisco, CA

Investment Banking Summer Analyst; Technology Media & Telecommunications Group

Jun 2025 – Aug 2025

- Engaged in M&A,

Select Transaction Experience:

- **Lead Left**
 - Drafted
- **Potential**
 - Analyzed
- **Potential**
 - Consolidated a

Bank of America Securities

Chicago, IL

Investment Banking Sophomore Summer Analyst; Global Industrials Group

Jun 2024 – Aug 2024

- Engaged in

Select Transaction Experience:

- **\$100mm**
 - Reviewed
 - Screened

AI RESEARCH & PROJECTS

Penn Genome and Frontier Institute | University of Pennsylvania

Philadelphia, PA

Research Assistant & Machine Learning Engineer

Jan 2026 – May 2026

- Built framework to study deep learning model's robustness in high-dimensional embeddings; generated manifold-like synthetic data, ran controlled perturbation sweeps, and evaluated stability with k-NN overlap, Spearman rank correlation, and ARI

Human Machine Intelligence Lab | Peking University

Beijing, China

Research Assistant & Machine Learning Engineer

Jan 2026 – Jun 2026

- Built an MCTS-guided SFT pipeline for UI-TARS-1.5-7B using 2,927 GUI-agent trajectories and 20,903 audited steps across 86 tasks; improved greedy single-run success rate from 12.3% to 17.7%, in preparation for a paper submission to NeurIPS 2026

Alternative Credit Lending LLM [\[github\]](#) [\[devpost\]](#) | HackPrinceton 2025

Princeton, NJ

Engineer

Jan 2026 – Jun 2026

- **Won 1st place in the Hybrid Intelligence track against 100 competitors**, and received \$1,000 in prizes and credits
- Built Wings, an AI financial coach and BNPL platform integrating Knot and Nessie transaction data into Snowflake and using Snowflake Cortex and OpenAI to deliver personalized spending insights across iMessage and web

LEADERSHIP & EXTRACURRICULAR

Ethoscope

Philadelphia, PA

Co-Founder, CEO & Backend Developer of AI Startup

Jan 2025 – Apr 2025

- Refined an LLM and UI that can capture and analyze individuals' personalities and sentiments across text and audio to provide frictionless insights from CRM integration; received sponsorship from the Wharton Statistics & LLM Lab

Humanities Online Platform for Everyone (HOPE)

Boston, MA

CEO & Editor-in-Chief

Jun 2020 – Present

- Managed a 501C nonprofit aiming to raise awareness on humanities & academic research (100K+ monthly views)

SKILLS, ACTIVITIES & INTERESTS

Languages & Skills: Mandarin, Excel, PowerPoint, FactSet, Python, MATLAB, R, Java, OCaml, SQL, PyTorch, HuggingFace

Activities: Wharton Investment and Trading Group, President of Penn Wharton China Summit and Wharton China Association

Interests: Sailing (Skipper), Soccer, Skiing, WSET Level 2 Wine Tasting, Squash, Volcano Hiking (Volcan de Fuego, Guatemala)